Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

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LEARNER GUIDE

For

Agentic AI for Affiliate Marketing

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Conducted by

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DOCUMENT VERSION CONTROL RECORD

Version Number	Effective Date of Release	Summary of Included Changes	Author
2.0	5 September 2026	Rebuilt affiliate-marketing edition: offer economics, research Skills, MCP-assisted partner due diligence, governed campaign production, attribution, commission reconciliation and reporting.	Dr Alfred Ang

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Course Overview

This guide supports the 2-day, 16-hour WSQ course Agentic AI for Affiliate Marketing (TGS-2025060552). It is the procedural companion to the concept-led slide deck. The six labs form one controlled affiliate programme: evaluate an offer, monitor trends, research partners, construct and coordinate a portfolio, create compliant multi-channel content, reconcile attributed activity and deliver an evidence-led progress report.

Learning Outcomes

- LO1: Analyze affiliate marketing trends and provide updates to partners on new retail and hospitality products and services.
- LO2: Coordinate with affiliates using strategic research to align partnerships and develop an effective affiliate portfolio.
- LO3: Prepare affiliate campaign reports aligned to strategy and ensure compliance with marketing policies and practices.

Assessment Alignment

- Written Assessment (WA-SAQ): three open-ended LO-grouped questions covering K1-K9, 60 minutes, open book.
- Case Study (CS): one coherent scenario with three integrated tasks covering A1-A5, 60 minutes, open book.
- Instrument, duration and LO-level mapping mirror the approved Assessment Plan; the Drive Assessment folder contained no legacy question papers.

Safety boundary: Use the supplied synthetic records and a bounded Claude Cowork workspace. Prefer read-only connectors. Remove credentials, personal data and unpublished commercial terms from prompts and evidence. Require named human approval before publishing, messaging, spending or changing commissions.

Environment Setup

1. Download or clone the course repository and confirm that all six lab folders contain a README, checklist, supplied data and an evidence folder.
2. Create a dedicated Claude Cowork workspace or project folder for this course; do not point it at production campaign or customer folders.
3. Keep the supplied sample files unchanged and copy them into a working subfolder before each lab.
4. If a connector is available, grant only the minimum read scope needed for the task and record the connector name, scope and audit identifier.
5. Create a human-review folder for exact previews, decisions, dates and payload hashes before any external action.
6. Run each deterministic validation script locally before asking an agent to interpret the output.

Agent rule: Claude may research, classify, draft and explain within the approved workspace. A named person remains responsible for source acceptance, partner selection, claims, release, spend, payout and optimisation decisions.

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Topic 01 - Affiliate Research and Campaign Planning with Claude Cowork

Market signals -> offer economics -> reusable research Skill -> evidence-led partner update

Concept model

- Model incentive economics with EPC, conversion, commission and break-even thresholds.
- Separate observed market evidence from agent inference and partner-facing recommendations.
- Package repeatable affiliate research and product-update work as a bounded Claude Skill.
- Use human review to control claims, pricing, disclosure, data use and external communication.

Lab 1 - Affiliate Offer Economics and Niche Fit

Duration	75 minutes
Alignment	LO1 | K1, K5, K6
Tools	Claude Cowork, spreadsheet/CSV, Python calculator, supplied product evidence
Deliverable	A source-backed offer scorecard and deterministic economics report.

Evaluate three retail and hospitality offers using the ebook-derived product criteria, current evidence, EPC, conversion, reversal and break-even models.

How the workflow works

- Load offer and traffic assumptions
- Validate denominators and dates
- Calculate EPC, CVR and break-even CPC
- Apply non-compensable fit and policy gates
- Human selects one pilot offer

Contract to preserve

- unique clicks are the EPC denominator
- approved conversions exclude reversals
- commission terms are effective-dated
- every qualitative score cites evidence
- hard policy gates run before ranking

Detailed step-by-step procedure

7. Open this lab folder and read README.md and offer-inputs.csv.
8. Choose one retail and one hospitality audience job to anchor the comparison.
9. For each offer, verify product name, price, commission model, rate, cookie window and reversal assumption against the supplied source note.
10. Run `python3 offer_economics.py offer-inputs.csv`.
11. Check that the report prints EPC, approved conversion rate, expected commission and break-even CPC.
12. Manually recompute Offer A EPC and compare it with the script output.
13. Change Offer B reversal rate to 18% and rerun the calculator.
14. Record which ranking changed and why.
15. Apply the audience-fit, proof and policy hard gates in the scorecard.

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16. Reject any offer that fails a hard gate even if its expected commission is highest.
17. Write a sensitivity note for conversion rate plus/minus one percentage point.
18. Select one bounded pilot offer and state the maximum paid CPC.
19. Save the generated report under evidence/ and complete CHECKLIST.md.

Acceptance criteria

- all numeric metrics recompute
- source dates recorded
- hard gates applied before ranking
- pilot has CPC ceiling
- no unsupported claim

Evidence to capture

- completed offer-inputs.csv
- offer-economics-report.md
- source notes
- selected offer and rationale
- one rejected offer with gate reason

Troubleshooting and failure handling

- missing denominator blocks calculation
- stale product evidence lowers confidence
- high rate cannot offset poor audience fit
- negative margin rejects paid traffic
- sensitivity range replaces false precision

Working files: Open the matching folder under labs/lab-01-*. Complete its README procedure and CHECKLIST.md. Workflow exports must contain no credentials.

Lab 2 - Trend Monitor and Product Update Skill

Duration	90 minutes
Alignment	LO1 | A1, A5
Tools	Claude Cowork, custom Skills, approved web sources, Markdown templates
Deliverable	A packaged custom Skill, trend evidence set and versioned product-update brief.

Create a reusable Claude Skill that turns approved trend signals and product changes into evidence cards and a reviewed affiliate update.

How the workflow works

- Skill receives bounded source folder
- Evidence cards separate observation and inference
- Product diff identifies partner impact
- Validator checks source/date/disclosure
- Human approves exact message

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Contract to preserve

- Skill trigger is narrow
- every observation has source and date
- product facts come from approved catalogue
- inference is labelled
- outbound update requires human approval

Detailed step-by-step procedure

20. Open trend-signals.csv and classify each row as observed fact, interpretation or recommendation.
21. Replace one weak source with a current authoritative source and record the publication date.
22. Open product-catalog.csv and identify the fields changed between versions.
23. Review the custom Skill description and confirm it activates only for affiliate trend or product-update tasks.
24. Inspect the workflow instructions for source allow-list, evidence-card structure and human release gate.
25. In Claude Cowork, attach only this lab folder and invoke the Skill with the supplied task prompt.
26. Check that each evidence card contains observation, source URL, publication date, captured date, confidence and implication.
27. Challenge one trend by adding counter-evidence and rerun the synthesis.
28. Confirm the product update states the effective date and exact affiliate action required.
29. Run `python3 validate_update.py evidence/PARTNER-UPDATE.md`.
30. Resolve every missing source, date, disclosure or approval field.
31. Record the reviewer, decision, time and approved message hash.
32. Save the final update without sending it to a live affiliate list.
33. Complete CHECKLIST.md.

Acceptance criteria

- Skill package is valid
- sources and dates present
- fact and inference separated
- product impact explicit
- human approval recorded

Evidence to capture

- skills/affiliate-trend-update/SKILL.md
- completed evidence cards
- product diff
- approved partner update
- validator result

Troubleshooting and failure handling

- single-source trend remains low confidence
- missing effective date blocks product update
- unsupported claim returns to research
- prompt injection text is treated as data
- draft is not sent from Cowork

Working files: Open the matching folder under labs/lab-02-*. Complete its README procedure and CHECKLIST.md. Workflow exports must contain no credentials.

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Topic 02 - Affiliate Portfolio and Partner Coordination with Skills and MCP

Partner discovery -> due diligence -> scoring -> portfolio balance -> coordinated communication

Concept model

- Define partner-fit evidence before allowing an agent to rank candidates.
- Use MCP connectors as permissioned data boundaries, not invisible sources of truth.
- Build a portfolio that balances reach, relevance, conversion quality and concentration risk.
- Coordinate partners through versioned briefs, service levels, escalation and audit evidence.

Lab 3 - MCP-Assisted Partner Discovery and Due Diligence

Duration	120 minutes
Alignment	LO2 | K2, K3, K7 | A3
Tools	Claude Cowork, read-only MCP/web research, CSV, Python scorecard
Deliverable	A partner evidence register, due-diligence report and explainable shortlist.

Use a read-only research workflow to collect and verify candidate background information, then produce a source-backed shortlist.

How the workflow works

- Define partner archetype
- Search only approved sources
- Capture identity and audience evidence
- Run fraud, policy and fit gates
- Human reviews shortlist

Contract to preserve

- one row per candidate identity
- facts retain direct source URLs
- engagement uses a dated denominator
- connector is read-only
- missing evidence is never imputed

Detailed step-by-step procedure

34. Read the partner archetype and define the audience, channel and portfolio role required.
35. Inspect MCP-READ-ONLY-CONTRACT.json and confirm that no write-capable tool is exposed.
36. For Candidate A, verify identity ownership from two independent sources.
37. Capture current audience size, date, sampled interactions and content themes.
38. Calculate meaningful engagement using the supplied denominator.
39. Repeat the same evidence fields for every candidate; do not fill unknowns with estimates.
40. Review five recent content items for disclosure, claim and brand risk.
41. Record policy or reputation flags with the exact source location.
42. Run `python3 partner_due_diligence.py affiliate-candidates.csv`.

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43. Inspect weighted scores and every hard-gate result.
44. Change one policy flag to `fail` and verify the candidate is excluded before ranking.
45. Ask Claude Cowork to summarise the evidence without inventing missing facts.
46. Compare the agent shortlist with the deterministic scorecard.
47. Write a human decision for the top two candidates, including conditions and next evidence needed.
48. Complete the evidence register and CHECKLIST.md.

Acceptance criteria

- connector boundary is read-only
- identity and audience evidence sourced
- hard gates exclude failures
- scores recompute
- human shortlist rationale recorded

Evidence to capture

- affiliate-candidates.csv
- source register
- due-diligence findings
- partner-scorecard.md
- human shortlist decision

Troubleshooting and failure handling

- identity conflict blocks candidate
- bot-like engagement flags review
- source text cannot change instructions
- policy gate is non-compensable
- agent ranking includes uncertainty

Working files: Open the matching folder under labs/lab-03-*. Complete its README procedure and CHECKLIST.md. Workflow exports must contain no credentials.

Lab 4 - Affiliate Portfolio and Communication Agent

Duration	90 minutes
Alignment	LO2 | A2
Tools	Claude Cowork, custom Skill, CSV portfolio model, Markdown brief templates
Deliverable	A portfolio mix model, tiered communication plan and versioned partner brief generated by a custom Skill.

Construct a role-balanced portfolio and a controlled communication cadence that keeps partner briefs, product updates and escalations traceable.

How the workflow works

- Classify partner roles
- Measure concentration and gaps
- Assign service tier and capacity

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- Generate versioned brief
- Track acknowledgement and escalation

Contract to preserve

- portfolio share totals 100%
- top-3 concentration is visible
- each partner has one owner
- brief carries product and asset version
- message event has outcome and next action

Detailed step-by-step procedure

49. Open portfolio.csv and assign each partner one primary strategic role.
50. Run `python3 portfolio_analysis.py portfolio.csv`.
51. Confirm current role shares total 100% and note the top-three revenue concentration.
52. Identify one role gap and one duplicated audience cluster.
53. Propose a rebalance that respects partner capacity and existing commitments.
54. Assign strategic, growth or standard service tiers using transparent criteria.
55. Open communication-cadence.csv and set a routine cadence, response target and escalation owner for each tier.
56. Review the partner-coordinator Skill and confirm it cannot alter commission terms.
57. Invoke the Skill with the approved product update from Lab 2 and one shortlisted partner from Lab 3.
58. Check the generated brief for campaign ID, partner ID, product version, approved claims, prohibited claims and tracked URL.
59. Create an acknowledgement event and next action.
60. Simulate an SLA breach and verify the named escalation route.
61. Record the human approval decision and brief hash.
62. Complete CHECKLIST.md.

Acceptance criteria

- portfolio shares reconcile
- concentration reported
- role gap identified
- brief versioned and approved
- SLA escalation works

Evidence to capture

- portfolio.csv
- portfolio-analysis.md
- communication-cadence.csv
- approved partner brief
- message and escalation log

Troubleshooting and failure handling

- duplicate audience creates hidden concentration
- old brief version is blocked
- SLA miss triggers named escalation
- agent cannot change commercial terms
- unacknowledged update stays open

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Working files: Open the matching folder under labs/lab-04-*. Complete its README procedure and CHECKLIST.md. Workflow exports must contain no credentials.

Topic 03 - Campaign Reporting, Compliance and Optimisation with Agentic AI

Tracked links -> event facts -> commission reconciliation -> policy checks -> controlled experiments

Concept model

- Preserve attribution grain from click and order events through commission settlement.
- Calculate traffic, conversion, revenue, commission and ROI with explicit denominators.
- Gate content and partner actions with disclosure, brand, privacy and policy controls.
- Convert dashboard evidence into reversible tests with human ownership and guardrails.

Lab 5 - Brand-Aligned Multi-Channel Campaign Factory

Duration	90 minutes
Alignment	LO3 | K4, K8, K9
Tools	Claude Cowork, custom Skill, JSON schema, deterministic compliance checker
Deliverable	A machine-readable campaign brief, four channel artifacts and a compliance release report.

Use a bounded content Skill to produce website, email, social and video briefs from one approved campaign contract, with disclosure and claim controls.

How the workflow works

- Load strategic brief
- Generate channel-specific drafts
- Preserve claim source IDs
- Run disclosure and brand checks
- Human approves exact versions

Contract to preserve

- one campaign objective
- one primary CTA per artifact
- tracked links identify channel and partner
- affiliate disclosure is prominent
- all factual claims cite approved sources

Detailed step-by-step procedure

63. Open campaign-brief.json and verify objective, audience, offer, partner, source IDs, prohibited claims and CTA.
64. Validate the brief with `python3 compliance_check.py campaign-brief.json`.
65. Review approved-claims.json and remove any claim that lacks current evidence.
66. Inspect the campaign-factory Skill output schema for website review, email, social post and video brief.

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67. Invoke the Skill in Claude Cowork using only the approved brief and claims files.
68. Confirm every channel artifact keeps the same offer version and core claim.
69. Check that each artifact adapts format and context rather than copying identical text.
70. Verify the affiliate disclosure appears before or with the endorsement.
71. Check each CTA uses the assigned partner and campaign tracking fields.
72. Run the compliance checker against the generated evidence folder.
73. Resolve missing disclosure, unsupported claim, broken link and prohibited-word findings.
74. Record the human reviewer and SHA-256 hash for every approved artifact.
75. Confirm no channel has been published or scheduled from the lab.
76. Complete CHECKLIST.md.

Acceptance criteria

- brief passes schema
- four channel artifacts created
- claims trace to sources
- disclosure passes
- human approval hashes recorded

Evidence to capture

- campaign-brief.json
- four channel drafts
- compliance-report.json
- resolved findings
- human approval hashes

Troubleshooting and failure handling

- channel draft cannot alter offer terms
- missing disclosure blocks release
- unsupported superlative is flagged
- brand and legal issues are separate
- no draft publishes automatically

Working files: Open the matching folder under labs/lab-05-*. Complete its README procedure and CHECKLIST.md. Workflow exports must contain no credentials.

Lab 6 - Attribution, Commission and Performance Reporting Agent

Duration	135 minutes
Alignment	LO3 | A4
Tools	Claude Cowork, CSV event data, Python reconciliation/report scripts, HTML dashboard
Deliverable	A reconciled event ledger, KPI dashboard, commission variance report and approved partner progress report.

Validate click and conversion facts, reconcile commission statements, calculate campaign KPIs and generate an evidence-led management report with controlled recommendations.

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How the workflow works

- Validate and deduplicate events
- Join click, order and partner keys
- Calculate deterministic metrics
- Agent explains variance with limitations
- Human approves actions and report

Contract to preserve

- immutable event identifiers
- approved revenue excludes reversals
- metric dictionary fixes denominators
- commission terms are effective-dated
- recommendations state owner and guardrails

Detailed step-by-step procedure

77. Open the three CSV files and identify click_id, order_id, partner_id, campaign_id and status fields.
78. Run `python3 reporting_agent.py`.
79. Review the validation section for duplicate clicks, unmatched orders and invalid statuses.
80. Quarantine the supplied duplicate event and rerun the script.
81. Reconcile approved revenue, reversal amount and payable commission with the network statement.
82. Investigate any variance above the stated materiality threshold.
83. Open metric-dictionary.md and manually recompute CTR, approved conversion rate, EPC and ROI for one partner.
84. Confirm every dashboard label states the denominator and reporting period.
85. Segment performance by partner and channel; identify the real bottleneck rather than the largest absolute number.
86. Ask Claude Cowork to explain the variance using only the generated facts and metric dictionary.
87. Require the narrative to separate observation, inference and recommendation.
88. Write one reversible optimisation experiment with primary metric, guardrails, sample/window and stop rule.
89. Review disclosure, privacy and brand implications before approving the recommendation.
90. Generate the final partner progress report with commission and activity sections.
91. Record owners, due dates and human approval, then complete CHECKLIST.md.

Acceptance criteria

- event validation passes
- commission variance resolved or explained
- metrics recompute
- dashboard and report generated
- recommendation has guardrails and owner

Evidence to capture

- click-events.csv
- conversion-events.csv
- commission-statement.csv
- reconciliation-report.md
- dashboard.html
- approved-progress-report.md

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Troubleshooting and failure handling

- duplicate events are quarantined
- unmatched orders remain unresolved
- commission variance exceeds threshold
- small samples lower confidence
- agent cannot change payout or publish report

Working files: Open the matching folder under labs/lab-06-*. Complete its README procedure and CHECKLIST.md. Workflow exports must contain no credentials.

Assessment Preparation

Use the following traceability map to prepare. The assessment tests the same contracts, workflows and evidence that appear in the deck and labs.

Criterion	What to demonstrate	Primary source
K1	Trends and practices in incentive frameworks and practices related to affiliate marketing	Topic 1 and Labs 1-2
K2	Organisation's affiliate marketing strategies	Topic 2 and Labs 3-4
K3	Relationship management with affiliate partners	Topic 2 and Labs 3-4
K4	Affiliate marketing campaign management	Topic 3 and Labs 5-6
K5	Organisation's current and emerging products and services related to affiliate marketing	Topic 1 and Labs 1-2
K6	Current and emerging affiliate marketing trends	Topic 1 and Lab 2
K7	Principles for constructing affiliate portfolios	Topic 2 and Lab 4
K8	Policies and guidelines around affiliate marketing efforts	Topic 3 and Labs 5-6
K9	Organisation's overall marketing strategy	Topic 3 and Labs 5-6
A1	Keep current with the latest affiliate marketing practices	Lab 2 evidence package
A2	Coordinate and communicate with affiliate partners on affiliate marketing activities	Lab 4 evidence package
A3	Collect background information pertaining to potential affiliates and partners	Lab 3 evidence package
A4	Prepare and deliver regular progress, commission and activity reports on affiliate	Lab 6 evidence package

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	partnerships	
A5	Update affiliates on latest products and services from own organisation	Lab 2 evidence package

Technical References

Supplied Ebook Foundation

- Affiliate Marketing-1.pdf: product-selection criteria, EPC, review writing, blogs, PPC/solo ads, conversion tracking, common mistakes and commission protection.
- Affiliate Marketing Beginners-2.pdf: foundations, niche selection, affiliate website setup, SEO, video/social/email/content promotion, branding and audience definition.

Current Product and Compliance Sources

- **Official course page:** https://www.tertiarycourses.com.sg/wsq-agentic-ai-for-affiliate-marketing.html
- **Claude Cowork help:** https://support.claude.com/en/articles/13345190-get-started-with-claude-cowork
- **Claude custom Skills:** https://support.claude.com/en/articles/12512198-how-to-create-custom-skills
- **Claude connectors and MCP:** https://support.claude.com/en/articles/11175166-get-started-with-custom-connectors-using-remote-mcp
- **Model Context Protocol:** https://docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/mcp
- **PDPC Singapore:** https://www.pdpc.gov.sg/
- **Advertising Standards Authority of Singapore:** https://asas.org.sg/

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